SRUJANA TECH FEST 2026

Participant Evaluation Guide

48-Hour Software Hackathon | 24 to 26 October 2026 | Finance and Legal Services

This guide explains the evaluation process, the criteria judges will consider, and how teams can prepare. Evaluation checkpoints are opportunities to explain your progress, demonstrate your approach, and receive questions or feedback.

1. Evaluation Schedule

When	Stage	What to expect
Day 1	Jury Connect	Jury members connect with teams, discuss their approaches, answer questions, and help identify blockers.
Day 2, 11:00 AM	Evaluation 1: Progress and Direction	Teams discuss problem understanding, technical strategy, early implementation, communication, and potential impact.
Day 2, 10:00 PM	Evaluation 2: Implementation and Readiness	Teams demonstrate progress, working functionality, technical decisions, demo quality, and real-world viability.
Day 3, 8:00 AM	Shortlist announcement	Ten teams from Finance and ten teams from Legal Services will be announced.
Day 3	Final jury round	Shortlisted teams present their projects live to the jury, followed by Q&A. Exact timing will be announced.

2. Official Evaluation Criteria

Criterion	Weight	What judges look for
Problem Statement	15	Alignment with the selected problem, clarity, depth of understanding, intended users, assumptions, and constraints.
Tech Strategy	20	Architecture, tool selection, data design, technical planning, and whether choices fit the problem.
Implementation	25	Execution quality, working prototype, code logic, functional completeness, reliability, and testing.
Presentation	20	Communication, storytelling, demo quality, and ability to answer questions and explain decisions.
Viability & Impact	20	Real-world usefulness, market or business value, scalability, risk management, and practical feasibility.
Total	100	The same criteria and weights apply across both themes.

3. How to Prepare

Problem Statement: Understand the real problem and the user affected. Identify what is difficult, why existing approaches may fall short, and what your solution changes.

Tech Strategy: Explain your architecture, data flow, tools, and major decisions. Use technology because it helps solve the problem, not to make the stack look complex.

Implementation: Build and test a real user journey. A smaller working solution with sound logic is more convincing than many incomplete features. Be honest about mocked or incomplete functionality.

Presentation: Explain the problem, your approach, what works, and why it is useful. Keep the demo focused and prepare to answer questions.

Viability & Impact: Consider who would use the solution, what benefit it provides, what could go wrong, and what is needed for real-world use.

4. Think Beyond the Obvious

The problem statements define the challenges, not the solutions. Think critically, question assumptions, and explore approaches that are creative and practical. A generic dashboard, chatbot wrapper, or prediction model is not automatically a strong solution. Ask: What makes this useful to a real user? What difficult case have we considered? What does our approach do differently? Can we demonstrate that it works? Originality matters, but innovation without implementation is only an idea. Aim for a distinctive, technically sound, functional, and useful solution. Choose one official problem statement from your theme. Custom problem statements are not allowed.

5. Submission Deadline

Submission	Deadline	Notes
Complete repository and documentation	48 hours after official start	Include source code, README or documentation, setup instructions, dependencies, and supporting files.

The hackathon began at 10:00 AM on Day 1. The complete repository and documentation deadline is 10:00 AM on Day 3. The shortlist will be announced at 8:00 AM on Day 3. The submission platform and exact instructions will be announced by the organizers.

6. Project Development Rules

- Choose one of the six official problem statements in your selected theme. Custom problem statements are not allowed.
- Existing libraries, frameworks, APIs, development tools, internet access, and public resources are allowed.
- A pre-built project may not be submitted as the solution. The project must be developed during the hackathon.
- AI tools are allowed, but teams must disclose their use and explain their implementation.
- Acknowledge significant external code, datasets, APIs, and dependencies. Do not claim another person's work as your own.

7. Facilities and Support

- Each team has one power outlet. Bring your own laptop, charger, college ID, and extension box.
- Beds are available in designated sleeping areas. Participants may continue working at their assigned tables.
- Snacks will be provided during the night.
- Mentors are available subject to their availability.
- For queries after the hackathon begins, contact your classroom volunteer. If the volunteer cannot resolve the issue, politely ask them to contact the organizers.

8. Conduct, Integrity, and Project Ownership

Treat participants, mentors, volunteers, judges, and organizers respectfully. Follow instructions, care for university property, and use data and external services responsibly. Harassment, disruptive behaviour, plagiarism, fabricated claims, deliberate misrepresentation, or serious misconduct may lead to disqualification. Project ownership and rights to use, display, or distribute submitted work are subject to official organizer terms. Contact the organizers for clarification.

9. Final Judging

Ten teams from each theme will be shortlisted. Shortlisted teams will present live to the jury, followed by Q&A. Be prepared to explain the problem, implementation, technical decisions, assumptions, limitations, and real-world value. Use feedback to improve, stay focused on the official problem, and make the remaining time count.